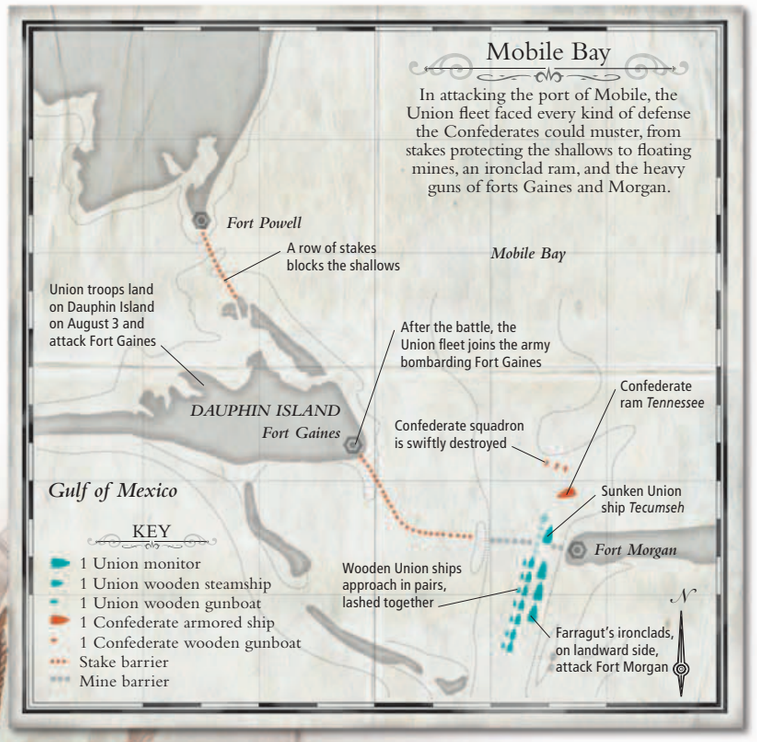
> SHOT AFTER SHOT WAS SEEN TO STRIKE, AND SHELLS TO EXPLODE ... BUT THEIR SIDES BEING HEAVILY PROTECTED ... NO VITAL BLOW COULD BE INFLICTED.
>
> **GENERAL RICHARD L PAGE**, COMMANDER OF FORT MORGAN

proved a tough opponent to overcome. Three of the Union screw-sloops, including Farragut's *Hartford*, rammed the Confederate leviathan, but suffered more damage than they caused. The monitors *Chickasaw* and *Manhattan* moved in to fire their heavy guns at point-blank range, finally succeeding in blowing a hole in *Tennessee*'s armor.

Buchanan, himself wounded, at last ordered a white flag flown from the battered, disabled ironclad, bringing the battle of Mobile Bay to a close.

Over the following weeks, Union army and naval forces captured the forts at the mouth of the bay, completing the blockade of Mobile, which itself stayed in Confederate hands.





1801–1870

DAVID G. FARRAGUT

THE FIRST ADMIRAL OF THE US NAVY

Tennessee-born David Farragut was a midshipman in the US Navy aged nine, and, during the 1812 War with Britain, commanded a prize vessel at the age of 12. He saw further action in the Mexican War of 1846–48. Although born and bred a southerner, in the Civil War he opted for the Union and distinguished himself in the running of the forts to New Orleans in 1862. The assault on Mobile Bay, in 1864, was his finest hour. He was rewarded with the title of admiral in 1866, the first man to hold that rank in the US Navy.

